

SRKR ENGINEERING COLLEGE (A)

Amendment to the Research Promotion Policy – 2026

The Research Promotion Policy of Sagi Rama Krishnam Raju Engineering College (SRKREC), approved in 2024, continues to remain in force. To align with emerging national priorities, accreditation requirements, innovation ecosystems, industry collaboration, and research excellence initiatives, the following amendments and additions are hereby incorporated with effect from the academic year 2026–27. All other provisions of the R&D Policy 2024 shall remain unchanged and continue to be applicable.

1. Centre of Excellence (CoE) driven Open Elective Courses

To strengthen industry-relevant and emerging technology education, all recognized Centres of Excellence (CoEs) shall be encouraged to offer Open Elective Courses under the R26 curriculum regulations. These courses shall focus on contemporary technologies, interdisciplinary applications, industry practices, and research-driven learning opportunities for students across departments.

- i) Drone Technologies
- ii) Sustainable Engineering Practices
- iii) Internet of Things (IoT)
- iv) Machine Learning for Engineering
- v) Quantum Technologies
- vi) Electrical Vehicle (EV) Technologies
- vii) GIS and Remote Sensing
- viii) Data analytics and Visualization

2. Best Thesis Awards

The Institute shall institute annual "Best Thesis Awards" for outstanding B.Tech Final Year Project work (two awards/program). The awards shall recognize originality, societal relevance, research quality, innovation potential, publications, patents, and contributions to knowledge creation.

3. Incentives for Institute–Industry Collaboration Coordinators

Faculty members serving as Single Point of Contact (SPOC) for Industry–Institute Collaboration MoUs shall be eligible for incentives and recognition based on the successful achievement of MoU objectives, including internships, industry projects, consultancy assignments, joint research, training programs, sponsored laboratories, and placement opportunities.

All active MoUs signed by the Institute shall undergo an annual performance audit by the Research and Development Cell. The audit shall assess the outcomes achieved against the objectives of the MoU, including collaborative research, student internships, industry engagement, faculty exchange, consultancy, skill development, and resource sharing. MoUs with limited activity may be reviewed for renewal or restructuring.

4. Promotion of Multidisciplinary and Collaborative Research

The Institute strongly encourages multidisciplinary and interdisciplinary research involving faculty members from two or more departments. Collaborative projects addressing societal, industrial, environmental, and technological challenges shall be given priority support through institutional resources and research initiatives.

For incentive claims related to Q1 journal publications, relaxation may be provided in cases where:

- All authors belong to SRKREC.
- The work is carried out primarily using in-house facilities and resources.
- The publication involves faculty members from two or more departments.
- The research demonstrates clear multidisciplinary objectives and significant quality outcomes.
- The publication appears in reputed Q1 journals (as per SJR).

5. Recognition and Rewards for Research and Professional Excellence

These guidelines shall be applicable to all such faculty members of the Institute whose academic achievements have been recognized at State, National and International Forums. For the purpose, recognition includes Award or Medal or Certificate of Recognition bestowed at any of the recognized Forums.

Recognized Forums includes any State, National and International level from Government/Govt. recognized bodies with a past track record. Participation/Presentation Certificates for Paper/Poster Presentation are not included for the purpose of these guidelines. In addition, intra/inter Institute awards are also excluded from these guidelines.

The faculty members, who are recipients of awards at any of the above defined recognized forums, shall apply to the Institute through the R&D Cell within the time limit prescribed by the Institute, giving details and supportive documents of the award received. On receipt of applications, a duly constituted Committee shall scrutinize each application and submit their recommendations to the Principal for approval.

The Institute shall honour such awardees by giving incentive in any of the following forms:

- i. Certificate of honour/appreciation letter
- ii. Announcement in SRKREC News Letter/Website
- iii. Medal
- iv. Cash award
- v. Career Advancement / Promotion (to be decided by Committee constituted from time to time)

vi. Salary Increment

vii. Any other incentive not included herein above, as deemed fit.

The Institute reserves the right to interpret, alter, amend, modify, cancel or withdraw any or all provision mentioned herein above in these guidelines without any notice.

In case of any dispute, decision of the Head of the Institute shall be final and binding.

Annexure - A

Centre of Excellence (CoE) Guidelines

The Centre of Excellence shall serve as a focused institutional platform for advancing research, innovation, technology development, capacity building, and industry–academia collaboration in identified thrust areas.

Objectives

- Develop technical and domain expertise in identified thrust areas.
- Identify research problems based on societal, regional, national, and industry needs.
- Undertake innovative and interdisciplinary research in the identified area.
- Develop, test, and validate research-based solutions.
- Promote the application and commercialization of research outcomes.
- Support industry, government, MSMEs, and community-based problem solving.
- Strengthen the institution's research and innovation ecosystem.
- Promote national and international collaborations.

Key Responsibilities of the CoE

- Track national and international developments in the identified domain.
- Identify emerging technologies, research gaps, and future opportunities. Form dedicated research groups for specific sub-areas.
- Provide research and capacity-building opportunities for faculty, researchers, and students.
- Organize workshops, training programmes, seminars, and technical programmes.
- Establish collaborations with universities, research institutions, industries, MSMEs, government agencies, and professional organizations.
- Develop joint research projects, consultancy projects, patents, publications, and technology solutions.
- Build a strong network among academia, industry, government, and other stakeholders.
- Facilitate technology development, testing, demonstration, and field implementation.
- Provide skill-development programmes for students, faculty, professionals, and external stakeholders.
- Maintain and strengthen CoE infrastructure, laboratories, equipment, and research facilities.
- Submit an annual activity and performance report to the institution.

CoEs Framework, Scope and Operational Guidelines

Scope should align:

- Faculty capacity building and student training
- Research
- Sustainability
- Innovation
- Industry collaboration

Expected outcomes should align:

- Building, implementing, and communicating best practices and tools to drive operational excellence to young graduates
- Opportunity to do internship at IITs/IISC/IIITs or industries
- Strong collaboration with external agencies
- Advancement equipment, and facilities
- Patents, products, prototypes, training programs, and impactful solutions
- Sustainability focus

Should have

- 1) Vision
- 2) Mission
- 3) Members (External – minimum 05 members): Prominent alumni from Industry and R&D align to the centre of excellence mission
- 4) Members (Internal – 05 members; minimum two departments involvement)
- 5) Roadmap for 2030
- 6) Outreach Activities – students training, outreach, and students' projects)
- 7) Publications, IPR, and Projects
(maintain regular updates)